

JVC EX-S1 dock

JVC launched its EX-S1 iDevice dock which is part of the Wood Cone lineup, it includes a USB port and auxiliary inputs

Leaf Aptus-II 12

The Leaf Aptus-II 12 priced at \$31,387 clicks 80 million pixels images; it also has a 3.5-inch touchscreen and click photos as large as 480MB in size

that doesn't really work too well, and is more likely to drive you batty than be any fun.

Social network integration: This is very popular now, and makes complete sense if you have a mobile internet plan. For those of you who don't use GPRS or EDGE, completely pointless.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Entry-level, dual-SIM phones which are all the rage nowadays are meant for users looking at extremely budget friendly phones with a decent feature set. Videocon Cruz V1430, Intex IN 6633, g-Fone 565 (The *Digit Best Buy* winner) are some of the phones we would recommend.

Rising above the entry-level market come the feature-rich phones meant for budget buyers, which include the range of teeny bopper phones such as the Samsung Corby Pro or LG Cookie series phones. They are available under ₹10,000 but they have resistive touchscreens which will deteriorate over time.

Operating system considerations make sense in the case of smartphones as here apart from productivity the feature set is also of prime importance. But with sub-



Samsung Corby Pro

₹10,000 Android phones starting to flood the market we would advise you to wait for a couple of months. As of this date if you want a good Android phone, you will have to increase your budget to around ₹15,000 to ₹25,000. HTC has great offerings in the form of Legend (₹24,000), Hero (₹21,000), Wildfire (₹16,000). Samsung recently came out with Galaxy 3 (around ₹12,000). Also the Sony Ericsson Xperia Mini Pro

(₹16,000) is a decent buy. At the higher-end segment you have the HTC Desire, Sony Ericsson Xperia X10, Motorola Milestone and Samsung Galaxy S. Waiting a few months is not going to drastically affect the price points as each handset manufacturer has stripped down versions of phones (HTC Wildfire for HTC Desire or Sony Ericsson Xperia X10 Mini Pro for Xperia X10). But before buying the phones, check the Android version. Most higher-end offerings should have Android 2.2 and a 1 GHz processor. Look for a higher internal memory capacity, as some phones do not allow storage of apps on the memory card.

BlackBerry phones are ideal for business use, but do not expect a wide variety of apps. For first time users the BlackBerry 8520 is quite affordable at around ₹12,000. BlackBerry is the gold standard as far as QWERTY keypads are concerned, so it is best to stick with that. BlackBerry has acquired Cellmania recently, so if you are a heavy applications user and want to switch to BlackBerry, it would make sense to wait a bit to see how the new apps come along. Also, prices may come down by 10 per cent or so.

Apple iPhone users or aspiring iPhone users are eagerly awaiting the launch of iPhone4 in India. Expect to shell out in excess of ₹40,000 for it though. There's a lot of hype around iPhones, but we expect Android phones to cut this down to size. Unless you absolutely must have an iPhone4 at all costs, we'd recommend that you take a good look



HTC Desire

at the Samsung Galaxy S. Although we'd all but forgotten about Windows Mobile phones, Windows Phone 7 OS has sparked our interest again. With features such as Xbox Live allowing you to sync your Xbox 360 with the phone, there's some promise there. However, since the OS has only been seen on prototypes, we don't recommend that you hold your breath or halt your buying for it.

**LASCIVIOUS LAP-MATES**

Get that mind out of the gutter, this is Digit. When we use lecherous language, we're almost always talking about gadgets.

This holiday season, thousands of you will set forth into the markets, drooling over laptops with a wad of cash (or plastic) in your hands. The problem is, if there's one category where you're completely spoilt for choice, it's this one. There are so many brands and so many models to choose from that you're bound to go crazy. We should know, we can barely keep up with testing one generation when another is launched. Only cell phones are more confusing to buy, but since you're spending considerably more on a notebook or netbook, making the right choice becomes all the more critical here.

Note or net

To start with, one of the most common questions readers ask us is "netbook or notebook?" It's a very hard question to answer if we don't know you. It all

